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Classroom Assignment Sheet

152183

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Subject: HISTORY Batch: RR33 Submission Date:

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Question - What were the key factors leading to the Battle of Plassey in 1757, and how did Siraj-ud-Daulah's policies regarding trade and foreign companies shape the conflict with British East India Company?

The root cause of Battle of Plassey is originating from "no clear line of succession" after the Bengal Nawab Alivardi Khan. This led to a war of succession between the grandson of Alivardi Khan - Siraj-ud-Daulah and Ghaseki Begum (daughter). British were the masterminds of taking advantage of such internal fights. British supported Ghaseki Begum but finally Siraj-ud-Daulah came to power. There were several key factors after Siraj came to power -

1) Lack of Diplomatic tactics -

Siraj didn't wanted to bow down on the dictates of Jagat Seths and East India Company by granting them the trade monopoly of Bengal.

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He decided to keep Bengal an open-competitive economy. He couldn't try to make British fight with French over trade monopoly by supporting one of them.

2.) Black Hole Tragedy - He attacked on St. Fort William Calcutta and tortured the civilians of Fort by locking them in a small room lacking ventilations. This highly increased tensions between British and Bengal.

Siraj repented this inhumane act by giving Calcutta back to British via Treaty of Alinagar but Robert Clive was a man of greed and he was not satisfied with it.

3.) Internal Treachery - The betrayal by internal allies like Mir Jafar (Military chief of Bengal forces) strengthened the Imperial ambition of British East India Company to rule Bengal instead of just trading.

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